

Youth employment: From seekers to innovators

Active participation in Govt schemes and **emphasis** on entrepreneurship **offer promising avenues** towards a brighter future for India's rural youth

Inversion is used here due to adverbial phrase (i.e. particularly concerning)

In 2023, India experienced a **notable surge** in unemployment rates, impacting both rural and urban areas. Particularly concerning **was the rise in urban unemployment**, **escalating** from 8.5% in October to 9.3% in November and further climbing to 10.1% in December, **mirroring** levels from a year prior. This surge has **undeniably heightened** stress among the younger generation, actively **seeking** job opportunities, with thousands applying for each available position. In the age of technology, however, **a paradigm shift** is encouraged—from job seekers to job providers.

The youth grappling with unemployment challenges **are** urged to redefine their goals and **leverage** their **potential** and skills. **Sayyed Toiba Kousar**, a 22-year-old resident of the border district Poonch in Jammu and Kashmir, **emphasises** the transformative role technology can play in the employment **landscape**. Through the strategic use of technology, the younger generation can not only secure employment but also **venture into** becoming job providers.

Azhar Ali, a 24-year-old cricket enthusiast, **underscores** the importance of effective facilities for skill **enhancement**. He believes that with the **provision** of adequate facilities, the youth can **excel** in their respective fields, significantly contributing to societal and national development. Azhar **contends** that timely access to essential facilities is **crucial** for the younger generation to play a more impactful role in the country's progress.

Muhammad Waqar, a 22-year-old, **advocates** for a focus on sports activities at the school level to divert youth from addictive behaviours and guide them towards establishing self-employment opportunities. Ajaz Hussain, aged 27, emphasises creating opportunities **aligned** with children's interests to inspire **self-reliance**, benefiting both the individual and the country. Rashid **highlights** the importance of parental involvement in identifying and **nurturing** their children's interests, guiding them towards the numerous opportunities available today in areas such as sports, the internet, singing, dancing, art, painting, photography, and sculpture.

In the current scenario, various skill-related schemes are being implemented by both central and state governments across India. **Notably, the National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM)**, operated by the Ministry of Rural Development, **stands out** as one of the most effective projects. This initiative focuses on promoting self-employment and supporting rural individuals, especially economically disadvantaged young men and women. In Jammu and Kashmir, the Jammu and Kashmir State Rural Livelihood Mission (JKSRLM) **oversees** the implementation of NRLM, aiming to **integrate** the poor into self-help groups and connect them with self-employment opportunities.

The primary goal of JKSRLM is to reach 66% of the rural population in 125 blocks of Jammu and Kashmir, providing **sustainable livelihood** opportunities to **uplift** them from poverty and enhance

their standard of living. The Indian government has initiated various poverty **alleviation** schemes to improve the quality of life for the poor. It is crucial for the youth to actively engage with and benefit from these government schemes, **fostering** self-reliance in employment matters and contributing to societal development.

To ensure the success of these schemes, relevant departments should actively provide information and guidance, encouraging their 100% implementation and timely achievement of goals. By **embracing** the shift from job seekers to job providers, youth can play a vital role in shaping a more **prosperous** and self-sufficient future for themselves and the nation. **[Practice Exercise]**

- **Venture into** (phrasal verb) – to start a new activity, start thinking in a new way, or start doing an activity in a new place जोखिम काम उठाना
- **Oversee** (verb) – supervise, superintend, inspect, administer, देखरेख करना
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

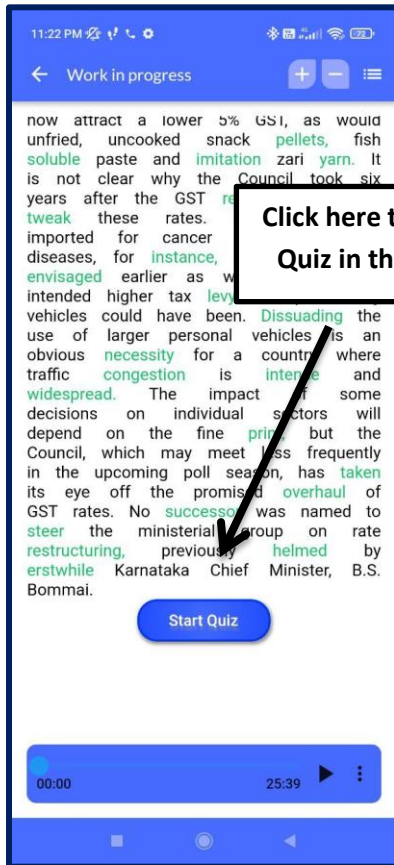
1. **Emphasis** (noun) – Stress, importance, significance, priority, accent जोर
2. **Promising** (adjective) – Hopeful, encouraging, optimistic, bright, auspicious आशाजनक
3. **Avenue** (noun) – Path, route, way, channel, course मार्ग
4. **Notable** (adjective) – Remarkable, outstanding, significant, noteworthy, distinguished उल्लेखनीय
5. **Surge** (noun) – Increase, rise, upsurge, growth, escalation वृद्धि
6. **Escalate** (verb) – Increase, intensify, amplify, heighten, raise बढ़ाना
7. **Mirror** (verb) – Represent, Illustrate, Symbolize, Signify, Embody दर्शाना
8. **Undeniably** (adverb) – Unquestionably, indisputably, certainly, definitely, surely निस्संदेह
9. **Heightened** (adjective) – Increased, intensified, amplified, enhanced, raised बढ़ा हुआ
10. **Seek** (verb) – Search, look for, pursue, quest, aim for खोजना
11. **A paradigm shift** (noun) – Fundamental change, transformation, revolution, overhaul, shift मौलिक परिवर्तन
12. **Grapple with** (phrasal verb) – Struggle with, deal with, confront, tackle, contend with से जूझना
13. **Leverage** (verb) – Utilize, exploit, use, take advantage of, capitalize on उपयोग करना
14. **Potential** (noun) – Ability, capability, capacity, talent, aptitude क्षमता
15. **Landscape** (noun) – Terrain, environment, scenery, surroundings, setting परिदृश्य
16. **Underscore** (verb) – Emphasize, highlight, underline, stress, accentuate जोर देना
17. **Enhancement** (noun) – Improvement, increase, augmentation, boost, elevation वृद्धि
18. **Provision** (noun) – the act of providing something
19. **Excel** (verb) – Surpass, outshine, excel, excel, outperform श्रेष्ठता प्राप्त करना
20. **Contend** (verb) – Argue, assert, maintain, claim, insist दावा करना
21. **Crucial** (adjective) – Critical, vital, essential, key, important महत्वपूर्ण
22. **Advocate** (verb) – Support, promote, endorse, champion, recommend समर्थन करना
23. **Align** (verb) – Align, align, align, align, align संरेखित करना

24. **Self-reliance** (noun) – Independence, self-sufficiency, autonomy, self-support, self-dependence आत्मनिर्भरता
25. **Highlight** (verb) – Emphasize, spotlight, underline, stress, accentuate प्रमुखता से प्रदर्शित करना
26. **Nurture** (verb) – Cultivate, foster, encourage, promote, develop पालन-पोषण करना
27. **Notably** (adverb) – Particularly, especially, significantly, remarkably, notably विशेष रूप से
28. **Stand out** (phrasal verb) – Distinguish, excel, shine, be prominent, be noticeable अलग दिखना
29. **Integrate** (verb) – Combine, merge, unite, blend, amalgamate एकीकृत करना
30. **Sustainable** (adjective) – Lasting, enduring, viable, feasible, maintainable टिकाऊ
31. **Livelihood** (noun) – Means of living, subsistence, income, sustenance, support जीविका
32. **Uplift** (verb) – Raise, elevate, lift, boost, improve उत्थान
33. **Standard of living** (noun) – Quality of life, living conditions, lifestyle, level of comfort जीवन स्तर
34. **Alleviation** (noun) – Relief, reduction, easing, mitigation, lightening हटाना
35. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, promote, nurture, cultivate, develop प्रोत्साहित करना
36. **Embrace** (verb) – Accept, adopt, welcome, take up, incorporate अपनाना
37. **Prosperous** (adjective) – Thriving, flourishing, successful, wealthy, affluent समृद्ध

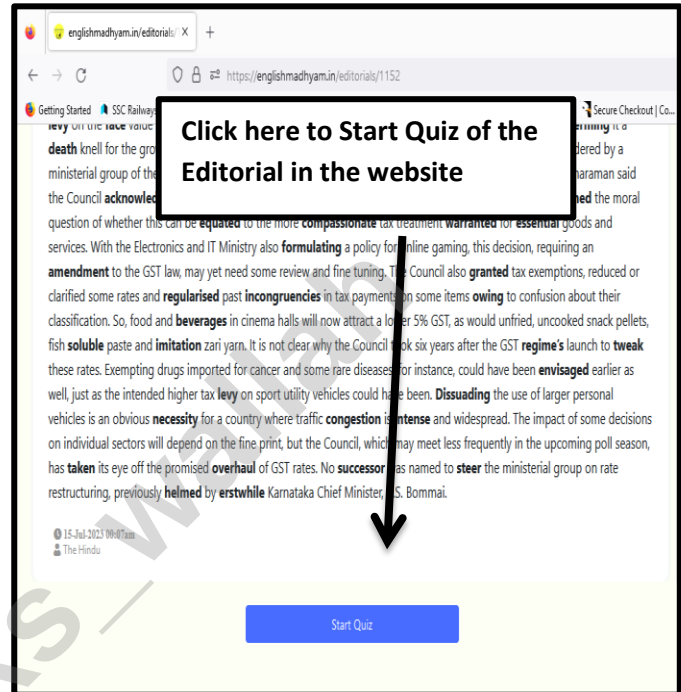
Summary of the Editorial

1. In 2023, India faced a surge in unemployment rates, affecting both rural and urban areas, with urban unemployment reaching 10.1% in December.
2. The rise in unemployment has increased stress among the youth, who are actively seeking job opportunities.
3. The editorial encourages a shift from being job seekers to job providers, leveraging technology and skills.
4. Sayyed Toiba Kousar, a 22-year-old from Jammu and Kashmir, highlights the role of technology in transforming the employment landscape.
5. Azhar Ali, a 24-year-old cricket enthusiast, emphasizes the need for facilities for skill enhancement to contribute to societal and national development.
6. Muhammad Waqar, 22, advocates for focusing on sports activities at the school level to divert youth from addictive behaviors and towards self-employment.
7. Ajaz Hussain, 27, stresses creating opportunities aligned with children's interests to inspire self-reliance.
8. Rashid highlights the importance of parental involvement in nurturing children's interests in various fields.
9. The National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM) is a significant project by the Ministry of Rural Development focusing on promoting self-employment and supporting economically disadvantaged youth.
10. In Jammu and Kashmir, the Jammu and Kashmir State Rural Livelihood Mission (JKSRLM) implements NRLM, aiming to integrate the poor into self-help groups and connect them with self-employment opportunities.
11. JKSRLM's primary goal is to reach 66% of the rural population in 125 blocks of Jammu and Kashmir, providing sustainable livelihood opportunities.
12. The Indian government has initiated various poverty alleviation schemes to improve the quality of life for the poor.
13. It is crucial for the youth to actively engage with and benefit from these government schemes to foster self-reliance in employment matters.
14. Relevant departments should actively provide information and guidance to ensure the success of these schemes.
15. By embracing the shift from job seekers to job providers, youth can play a vital role in shaping a more prosperous and self-sufficient future for themselves and the nation.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



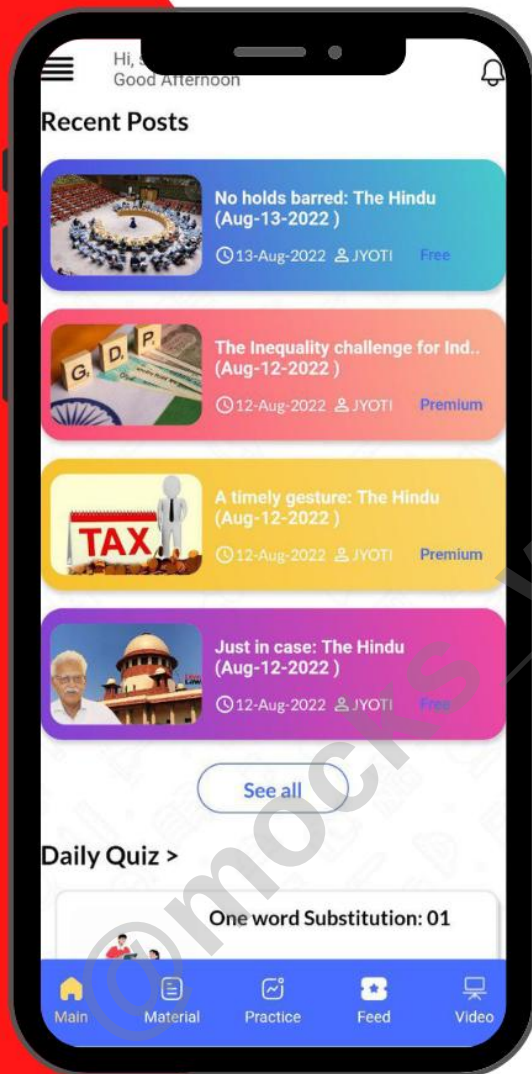
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